ASP.NET Core LaunchSettings.json File

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In this article, I'am going to discuss the launchsettings.json file in ASP.NET Core application. Please read our previous article discussing the ASP.NET Core Configuration Binding Options with Examples.

ASP.NET Core launchsettings.json File

The launchsettings.json file in ASP.NET Core is a configuration file used to configure how the application starts during development. It defines various settings for launching the application, such as the URL to use, environment variables, and profiles for different scenarios. This file is typically located in the Properties folder of an ASP.NET Core project.

The launchsettings.json contains configurations for different profiles, which specify how the application should run in different environments (e.g., development, staging, production). Common settings include the URL to use (e.g., localhost:5000), environment variables, and more. This allows developers to easily switch between different launch configurations without modifying the application code.

Key Settings of launchsettings.json File

The following are some of the key settings that can be set in the launchsettings.json file:

- **Profiles Configuration:** Defines multiple launch profiles for different scenarios (e.g., running with IIS Express, headless mode, Docker).
- **Environment Variables:** Specifies environment variables that are available when the application is run, influencing its behavior based on the environment.
- **Application URLs:** Specifies the URLs the application will listen on during development.
- **Command Line Arguments:** Allows specifying command line arguments that are passed to the application when it starts.

Example to Understand launchsettings.json File in ASP.NET Core

Let's create the ASP.NET Core Web Application using the Razor Pages template. Once you have created, ASP.NET Core Web Application, open the Properties folder and you will see the folder as shown in the following image.

Once you click on the Create a new project, it will open the Create a new project window. From the window, choose the ASP.NET Core Web App (Razor Pages) template and click on the Next button. Provide the project name as ASPNETCoreWebApp and choose the location. Finally, click on the Create button.

Once you click on the Next button, it will open the Configure your new project window. In this window, you need to select .NET 8 as the Framework, you may want to change the Project name to ASPNETCoreWebApp and the Location to the location where you want to store the project. Finally, click on the Create button.

Once you click on the Create button, it will open the Additional information window. Here, you need to select .NET 8 as the Framework, you may want to change the Authentication type to None, and finally, click on the Create button.

Now, you can see the Properties folder and the launchsettings.json file as shown in the following image.

As you can see in the above image, the launchsettings.json file contains two profiles, namely **ASPNETCoreWebApp** and **IIS Express**. Let's open the launchsettings.json file and see what is inside. Double click on the launchsettings.json file to open it in the Visual Studio editor. Finally, click on the Save button to save the changes.

Understanding launchSettings.json File in ASP.NET Core

The launchsettings.json file in ASP.NET Core defines various profiles that specify how the application should run in different environments. Each profile can specify settings such as the URL to use, environment variables, and more. This file is typically located in the Properties folder of an ASP.NET Core application for the Visual Studio.

Let's take a look at the default contents of the launchsettings.json file. As you can see, it contains two profiles, namely IIS Express and ASPNETCoreWebApp. Each profile specifies settings for how the application should be launched in different scenarios. For example, in the IIS Express profile, the application is configured to use IIS Express, and in the ASPNETCoreWebApp profile, the application is configured to run as a console application.

ASPNET Core launchSettings.ts File

Let's open the ASPNETCoreWebApp.csproj file and add the following code snippet to the ASPNETCoreWebApp.csproj file. This will ensure that the launchsettings.ts file is generated when the project is built.

```
<ItemGroup>
  <Content Include="Properties\launchSettings.ts" />
</ItemGroup>
```

Save the changes and rebuild the project. After rebuilding, you will see the launchsettings.ts file in the Properties folder as shown in the following image.

Open the launchsettings.ts file, and you will see the following code.

```
export const enum LaunchSettingsEnum {
    IISExpressAspNetCoreWebApp = "IIS Express",
    ASPNETCoreWebApp = "ASPNETCoreWebApp",
}
export interface ILaunchSettings {
    readonly $schema: "http://schemastore.azurewebsites.net/schemas/json/launchsettings.ts.schema.0.0.0.0.1.0.0.0.1.0.0.0.1
```

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